

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) |
Detection Strategy | Threat Hunting | Security Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience leading complex security operations, shaping detection strategy, and owning Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms at enterprise scale. I have deep technical ownership of Microsoft Sentinel, including data connectors, analytics rules, workbooks, and SOAR playbook development using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and PowerShell. I hold expert-level proficiency in CrowdStrike Falcon across the NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, and have led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment across an 8,000-user estate. I excel at shaping detection rules, tuning signal-to-noise ratios, building SOAR playbooks, and leading escalated security incident response and advanced threat hunting operations. I am a strong communicator who can articulate complex security findings to technical and non-technical stakeholders, and I bring the operational maturity and engineering depth to take real technical ownership across the full defensive lifecycle.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Ownership and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors, SOAR playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; detection rule authoring, correlation logic, signal-to-noise tuning
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbook development (Logic Apps), PowerShell automation scripts, alert enrichment and automated triage workflows
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** Escalated incident response aligned to NIST 800-61; advanced threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework; proactive hypothesis-led hunting across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based vulnerability prioritisation and remediation oversight
- **Security Tooling:** Mimecast, Tanium, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Check Point Harmony, Splunk/SPL
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Own Microsoft Sentinel end-to-end, including data connector configuration, analytics rule development in KQL, custom workbooks, SOAR playbook authoring (Logic Apps and PowerShell), and ongoing tuning of signal-to-noise ratios across high-volume alert categories.
- Lead detection strategy for the organisation, mapping detection coverage to MITRE ATT&CK techniques and identifying and closing gaps in telemetry and logic; maintain and continuously improve the detection library.

- Own CrowdStrike Falcon platform management across NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, performing advanced threat hunting, behavioural detection engineering, and custom indicator-of-compromise (IOC) management.
- Lead escalated incident response operations aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, performing triage, containment, forensic investigation, eradication, and post-incident review for high-severity and complex security events.
- Conduct advanced threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, developing and executing hypothesis-led hunting campaigns informed by threat intelligence and current adversary TTPs (Tactics, Techniques and Procedures).
- Manage Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, and Defender for Identity across the estate, owning custom detection rules, alert suppression, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified XDR visibility.
- Develop SOAR automation to enrich, correlate, and auto-respond to security alerts, significantly reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common alert patterns.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), overseeing privileged session management and least-privilege enforcement across Windows, Linux, and cloud environments.
- Manage Entra Identity Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies, and Intune MDM/MAM device compliance frameworks.
- Lead vulnerability management activities using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, producing executive-level reporting on risk posture and remediation progress.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Authored and maintained SIEM analytics rules and correlation logic, continuously tuning detections to reduce false positives and improve detection fidelity.
- Performed Tier 2 and Tier 3 security incident response, leading investigations, root-cause analysis, and remediation for complex or escalated security events.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying indicators of compromise and anomalous behaviours across endpoint, network, and identity telemetry.
- Supported the deployment and onboarding of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and BeyondTrust PAM across the estate, contributing to configuration, policy design, and user onboarding.
- Administered Azure Active Directory / Entra Identity IAM functions, including access reviews, MFA enrolment, and SSO integrations.
- Contributed to vulnerability management activities, scanning, triaging, and coordinating remediation in collaboration with infrastructure and application teams.
- Developed internal security documentation, detection runbooks, and incident response playbooks to support SOC operations and knowledge transfer.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered security engineering across a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech cloud environment, implementing endpoint protection, IAM controls, and network security hardening measures.
- Supported security monitoring, log management, and incident response activities, establishing baseline detection and response processes in a high-growth technology environment.
- Managed endpoint security policies, MFA, and access control configurations, aligning controls to CIS benchmarks and organisational security policies.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and implemented a comprehensive detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel at UAL, building a library of KQL-based analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, materially improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates.

- Led the Microsoft Defender XDR deployment across an 8,000-user estate, integrating Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender with Microsoft Sentinel for end-to-end extended detection and response visibility.
- Built and deployed an automated SOAR incident response pipeline using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell, cutting manual analyst handling time for high-volume alert categories and reducing MTTR significantly.
- Owned CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM platform engineering, including data onboarding, detection rule development, and ongoing signal-to-noise optimisation, improving overall SOC efficiency and analyst throughput.
- Led advanced threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, identifying and containing previously undetected threat actor activity across endpoint and identity layers.
- Delivered the BeyondTrust PAM implementation, eliminating standing privileged credentials and enforcing just-in-time access across server and cloud infrastructure.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.), Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.), Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000 | Hybrid (Manchester/UK)